

Sunday, 20 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 20° 16°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 18° 13°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 17° 13°	GLASGOW Drizzle 16° 11°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Billionaire Sir Jim Ratcliffe, owner of Manchester United, says he's lost confidence in the UK, claiming the country is "on the slide."

The Ineos founder told the BBC he believes more investment is needed in the North Sea. His comments come amidst broader discussions about the UK's economic future.

ECONOMY · UK
- 2

Parents could face losing benefits or even prison if their children commit crimes, under proposed reforms to Parenting Orders.

Jake Richards MP told The Times that these changes aim to increase parental accountability. It's a move that could significantly impact families across the UK.

LAW · UK
- 3

Get ready for some sunshine next week, as temperatures across parts of the UK could reach a balmy 26 degrees Celsius!

After a rather changeable week, drier and warmer conditions are set to dominate for many. However, those needing rain might still be waiting.

WEATHER · UK
- 4

A major fire at a seaside hotel in Folkestone is being treated as suspicious, with around 280 people evacuated.

The incident occurred at the Grand Burstin Hotel, prompting a large emergency response. Investigations are now underway into the cause.

INCIDENT · UK
- 5

Liberal Democrat leader Ed Davey has declared his party a "firewall against Farage" as their conference kicks off.

Mr Davey stated the Lib Dems are aiming to surpass their 2024 record of 72 MPs in any future snap election. It sets the tone for their conference agenda.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

1 **Actress Daisy Edgar-Jones says she often tries to 'bury her emotion' when it comes to love, much like her latest character.**

She revealed this insight while discussing her role in the new adaptation of 'Sense and Sensibility.' The star is currently busy promoting the highly anticipated production.

ON AIR – Do you think it's better to be open with emotions or keep them guarded in relationships?

FILM & TV · NOW

2 **Previously unheard music from the early days of David Bowie's career is now available to stream for the very first time.**

This exciting release offers fans a rare glimpse into the formative years of the iconic artist. It's a treasure trove for anyone interested in Bowie's musical journey.

ON AIR – What's the best 'lost' track from a famous artist you've ever discovered?

MUSIC · NOW

3 **The creators of 'Shaun the Sheep' say they don't see Artificial Intelligence as a threat to the film industry.**

The Bristol-based studio, Aardman Animations, has just released the third feature film in the beloved 'Shaun the Sheep' franchise. They remain confident in human creativity.

ON AIR – Do you think AI will eventually take over creative jobs like film-making, or will human ingenuity always prevail?

FILM & TV · NOW

4 **Harry Styles has treated fans in London by funding free coffees at two central cafes today!**

The superstar singer picked up the tab for customers at both Kaffeine locations in the capital. It's a lovely gesture from the global pop icon.

ON AIR – If a celebrity funded free coffees for you, which star would you love it to be?

MUSIC · TODAY

5 **Welsh actor Matthew Rhys made Emmy history by becoming the first person to win two lead acting prizes in one night!**

The star described the experience as 'surreal' when speaking to the BBC. It's a remarkable achievement for the talented actor.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Matthew Rhys role, and what makes him such a captivating actor?

FILM & TV · RECENT

On the schedule

1

England's T20 cricket team has crushed Sri Lanka to complete a 3-0 series clean sweep and reclaim the number one world ranking!

They steamrollered Sri Lanka in the third T20, showcasing a dominant performance. It's a fantastic achievement for the squad.

ON AIR – Are England now the team to beat in T20 cricket, and who do you think is their most valuable player?
CRICKET · UK

2

England's remarkable winning run in rugby has come to an end after a frenetic 26-26 draw against Canada at Sandy Park.

It was a nail-biting encounter that saw Canada halt England's impressive streak. A truly gripping match for both sides.

ON AIR – Was this draw a fair result, or do you think England should have secured the win?
RUGBY · UK

3

Brentford has maintained their unbeaten start to the Premier League season by putting three goals past Chelsea!

They scored all three goals in the second half to secure a dominant 3-0 victory at the Gtech Community Stadium. A brilliant performance from the Bees.

ON AIR – Can Brentford keep this unbeaten run going, and how much trouble are Chelsea really in?
FOOTBALL · UK

4

Tottenham's problems continue as they slipped to a home defeat against Aston Villa, with 'no revival in sight' for the 'fragile' Spurs.

This loss adds to their Premier League misery, leaving fans questioning the team's direction. It's a tough time for the North London club.

ON AIR – What do Spurs need to do to turn their season around, and who's to blame for their current form?
FOOTBALL · UK

5

Danny Tudhope has won his second Ayr Gold Cup on Pellitory, after a lengthy delay due to heavy rain!

The race, for trainer David O'Meara, saw Pellitory triumph despite the challenging conditions. A great win for both jockey and trainer.

ON AIR – What's the most memorable horse racing moment you've witnessed, especially when the weather played a part?
HORSE RACING · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A delightful new trend sees people embracing 'slow travel' across the UK, focusing on local discoveries.**
Instead of rushing, holidaymakers are taking their time, exploring charming villages and enjoying the scenic routes, often by train or bicycle. It's all about soaking in the atmosphere and finding those hidden gems just around the corner.
- 2 Gardeners are finding joy in 'upcycling everyday items' to create quirky and sustainable planters.**
From old wellington boots to vintage teapots, creative Brits are transforming household objects into unique homes for their flowers and herbs. It adds a lovely touch of personality to any garden space.
- 3 Research suggests that 'reading aloud' to yourself or others can significantly boost memory and understanding.**
Apparently, the act of vocalising words helps to engage more parts of the brain, making information stick better. So, if you're trying to remember something, try saying it out loud!
- 4 The simple pleasure of 'picnics in unexpected places' is gaining popularity for a refreshing break.**
Instead of the usual park bench, people are seeking out quiet corners, historical ruins, or even their own back gardens for an impromptu al fresco meal. It's a wonderful way to enjoy the everyday.
- 5 A charming new study highlights how 'collecting interesting pebbles' from walks can be a calming pastime.**
The act of searching for unique stones along riverbanks or beaches, and then arranging them, is proving to be a wonderfully meditative activity. It's a lovely way to bring a little bit of nature indoors.
- 6 British bakers are rediscovering the art of 'heritage bread making', using traditional techniques.**
From sourdough to regional specialities, there's a growing appreciation for slow-fermented loaves with deep flavours. It's bringing back the authentic taste of old-fashioned bread.
- 7 A new report finds that 'listening to classical music' can help improve concentration during daily tasks.**
Many people are discovering that a little bit of Mozart or Bach in the background can create a calming and focused environment, perfect for working or relaxing. Perhaps it's worth a try!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of crisps will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: LOOKING FOR THE CRINKLIEST, MOST GOLDEN-LOOKING CRISP AT THE TOP OF THE PACKET!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, new cup of tea, especially if it's a special blend. What is it?

ANSWER: GIVING THE TEABAG OR LOOSE LEAF A GOOD SNIFF BEFORE ADDING WATER!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular phrase or saying' that your grandparents or an older relative used to say just pops into your head, and it instantly makes you smile?

Perhaps it's something wonderfully old-fashioned or just a bit quirky. What's a lovely, nostalgic phrase or saying that you remember from an older family member?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday household item' that, despite its simplicity, you genuinely couldn't imagine your kitchen or living room without because it's just so useful or brings you joy, don't we?

It could be a favourite mug, a trusted bottle opener, or even a particular tea towel! What's that one humble item you absolutely love?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of ferrets is called a 'business'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's said that if you whisper to a houseplant, it will grow faster due to the carbon dioxide in your breath, but only if you whisper positive affirmations.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£32 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£32 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The inventor of the Pringle, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one of the iconic Pringle cans.
- Bears are born without hair, teeth, or the ability to see.
- The world's first webcam was created in 1991 to monitor a coffee pot at Cambridge University.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- The highest number ever counted to out loud by a human is one million, and it took 89 days.
- The smell of freshly cut grass is actually a plant distress call.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.

On this day

Day 263 of the year, 102 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Eustace (Western Christianity); Christian feast day: Evilasius; Christian feast day: Fausta of Cyzicus; Christian feast day: Glycerius of Milan. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1968 — Philippa Forrester, English television and radio presenter, producer and author
- 1990 — Phillip Phillips, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1951 — Debbi Morgan, American actress
- 1975 — Moon Bloodgood, American actress
- 1953 — Steve Tom, American actor
- 1966 — Nuno Bettencourt, Portuguese singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1938 — Eric Gale, American guitarist and producer (died 1994)
- 1969 — Ben Shepherd, American musician and songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 2001 — In an address to a joint session of Congress and the American people, U.S. President George W. Bush declares a "war on terror".
- 1962 — James Meredith, an African American, is temporarily barred from entering the University of Mississippi.
- 1971 — Having weakened after making landfall in Nicaragua the previous day, Hurricane Irene regains enough strength to be renamed Hurricane Olivia, making it the first known hurricane to cross from the Atlantic Ocean into the Pacific.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2000 — The United Kingdom's MI6 Secret Intelligence Service building is attacked by individuals using a Russian-built RPG-22 anti-tank missile.
- 1989 — USAir Flight 5050 crashes into Bowery Bay during a rejected takeoff from LaGuardia Airport, killing two people.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1979 — A French-supported coup d'état in the Central African Empire overthrows Emperor Bokassa I.

- 1955 — The Treaty on Relations between the USSR and the GDR is signed.
- 1946 — The first Cannes Film Festival is held, having been delayed for seven years due to World War II.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 264 of the year, 101 days left in 2026. Today Autumnal equinox observances in the Northern Hemisphere, vernal equinox observances in the Southern Hemisphere (see September 22): Spring Day (Argentina); Christian feast day: Cadoc; Christian feast day: Ephigenia of Ethiopia; Christian feast day: Laurent-Joseph-Marius Imbert (one of the Korean Martyrs). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1936 — Dickey Lee, American pop-country singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1970 — Melissa Ferrick, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1979 — Julian Gray, English footballer
- 1943 — David Hood, American session bassist and trombone player
- 1974 — Andy Todd, English footballer and manager
- 1990 — Christian Serratos, American actress
- 1990 — Danny Batth, English footballer
- 1949 — Henry Butler, American pianist and photographer (died 2018)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1997 — St. Olaf's Church, a stone church from the 16th century in Tyrvää, Finland, is burnt down by a burglar.
- 1977 — Malév Flight 203 crashes near Urziceni, killing 29 people.
- 2019 — A 5.6 Mw earthquake shakes the Albanian port of Durrës. Forty-nine people are injured in the capital, Tirana.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1981 — Sandra Day O'Connor is unanimously approved by the U.S. Senate as the first female Supreme Court justice.
- 2018 — LGBT rights activist Zak Kostopoulos is beaten to death on a busy street in Athens.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar